

Expertspeak



Veena Aggarwal

Nutritionist, Delhi

What she eats:

Breakfast: Besan or sprouted moong dal chilla.

Lunch: Salad and chapatti. For an elaborate fare, boiled brown rice, seasonal vegetables, a protein-rich curry and curd or raita.

Dinner: Same as lunch. Add a soup, salad, whole wheat or multi grain bread, a sauteed mixed vegetable and fruit yogurt.

Her tips

Have four-five meals a day. Include fruits and vegetables that are rich in vitamins and antioxidants.



Preeti Chhabra

Nutritionist, Delhi

What she eats:

Breakfast: Like a king. Splurge on a variety of nutritionally rich food.

Lunch: Like a commoner. Be a little conscious while eating.

Dinner: Like a pauper. Make it so meagre that it doesn't tax the digestive system when the body is at rest during sleep.

Her tips

Eat only when you are hungry, i.e., only when the previous meal is digested. Food should be warm and unctuous. One should eat to one's half capacity.

samosas translated into fat," says Mita Shukla, chief dietician with Wockhardt Hospitals in Kolkata. The only way out, she explains, "is to listen to experts you can trust".

The World Health Organisation (WHO) has set guidelines on how much you should consume if you want to remain healthy and not gain weight. Sedentary workers are recommended 20-25 Cals per kg of body weight in a day, moderately active people require 26-30 Cals and strenuous workers 31-35. The guidelines say that a deficit of 7,500 Cals will produce a weight loss of approximately a kilo. A simple calculation of calories could help as well. According to WHO, overweight and obese people shouldn't eat more than 20 Cals per kg in a day, while people who aren't overweight should limit it to 30. Underweight people should indulge in around 40 Cals. Scientists are now recommending the polym meal as a healthy option to check cardiovascular diseases. It is a safer, healthier and tastier option than the polypill (a wonder pill that promised to slash the risk of heart attacks and strokes by 80 per cent). According to an article in the *British Medical Journal*, the polym meal not only reduces the risk of cardiovascular diseases by 76 per cent, it also increases life expectancy in men and women by 6.6 and 4.8 per cent, respectively. The polym meal is an evidence-based menu that includes wine (150 ml per day), fish (114 gm four times a week), dark chocolate (100 gm per day), fruits and vegetables (400 gm a day), garlic

If the Atkins diet tells us to ban cereals, the GM diet proposes the opposite and asks us to live on bananas and milk for a day. And for those of you who are looking for the perfect diet to stay healthy, here is what a new research has to say. Diets do not mean much. The research conducted by scientists at the University of California, Los Angeles, says, no matter how much weight you lose by dieting, it will always come back. And to make matters worse, when the weight comes back, it's likely to be a few kilos more than what it was. "Since most fad diets are very low on calories, they cause fast weight loss. That, however, may not be healthy and—in most cases—is not fat loss. It is usually water-loss, which is quickly regained when the dieter resumes normal eating," says Aggarwal. "We never really understood the concept of calories. Roti and aloo subzi meant a filling, yet low-calorie meal, but the same ingredients used to make

(2.7 gm per day) and almonds (68 gm a day). Ramesh Javvaji, executive chef of ITC Hotel The Sonar in Kolkata, says that we can, to some extent, take pointers from the polym meal to suit Indian diets, but again, we have to keep in mind that everything is not adaptable.

Although there are too many diets and dieticians in the market, experts agree that there is scope for improvement even in traditional diets. Nothing is sacrosanct in any particular diet. "Science does not stay in one particular place," says Shukla. "In college I was taught that mustard oil is heavy on stomach. Now, a new research tells me I should prescribe mustard oil," she says. That only goes on to prove the point that even traditional foods can evolve. It is absolutely true. How else would the circuit in our brain go on programming itself life-long? And decide whether the chocolate-endorsing polym meal is better than grandma's cooking? ■

27%
households in
urban India now
eat chicken.